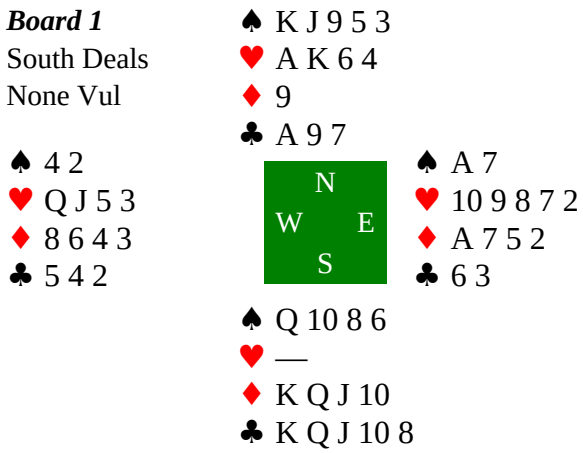
Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by North
Lead: ♣6

You have a very big hand. But there is no need to start jumping before you know whether you have a fit. So just bid 1♠, partner cannot pass this bid.

Partner now surprises you with a jump to 3♠!.

Wow! Partner has 16 and you have more than that. Slam appears certain, by why not check for Aces? So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♣. What do you say next?

You probably say "Oh Darn!" or perhaps something less printable. But then you just sign of at 5♠.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 10 6
♥ 7 5
♦ K Q 9 5 3
♣ 9 7 4

♠ Q J 8 7 4
♥ 9 4
♦ 7 2
♣ A 10 8 5

♠ A 5 3 2
♥ Q J 10 6 3 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 3

♠ 9
♥ A K 8
♦ A J 10 6 4
♣ K Q J 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	5♦		
All Pass			

5♦ by South
Lead: ♠Q

That is great support, but always remember when supporting a Minor that partner might have only 3 of them. So you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 4♦.

You were cautious with your first bid, but that is over now. Partner didn't open with a 3-card suit, he really has ♦s. He bypassed 3NT in a flash, so he has no interest in playing anywhere but a ♦ contract. He invites you to bid game if you have something extra above the 6 points you already promised. You have a lot more than that, so you bid 5♦.